



## AFTER

The restoration of peace left huge questions about the direction the reunited nation would take. First and foremost, former Confederate soldiers had to be resettled.

### LIVES TO REBUILD

By the **terms offered to Robert E. Lee and his army at Appomattox Court House** (see [The Appomattox Campaign](#)), soldiers who surrendered were **free to return home** with their horses or mules and, in the case of officers, with their sidearms as well. They carried with them **signed parole passes** that guaranteed them the right to remain undisturbed as long as they kept their paroles and "the laws in force where they reside."

Yet many soldiers returned to find their homesteads ravaged. In addition, the former Confederacy's **transport infrastructure had been badly damaged**, with much of the region's rail network destroyed. A huge task of **national reconstruction lay ahead** (see [The Reality of Black Freedom](#)).